

Reflective Journal

Course: ITAI2373 Final Project

Phase 1: Advanced NLP & Scaling

Technical Growth

Transitioning from basic NLTK to the Hugging Face transformers library was a major milestone. We learned the importance of model selection—choosing DistilBART allowed us to perform summarization efficiently without requiring high-end GPU resources in the local environment.

Phase 2: Multilingual Hurdles

Problem Solving

We encountered significant issues with googletrans API timeouts. Our solution was to implement a robust exception handling block and specific version pinning (3.1.0a0) to ensure stability during the final demo. This taught us that production-ready AI often requires working around API limitations.

Conclusion: Team Collaboration

Reflections

The project underscored the value of modular programming. By assigning specific "Intelligence Modules" to different team members, we were able to integrate the final pipeline seamlessly. This capstone has prepared us for real-world NLP engineering challenges.
